

This Patient Group Direction (PGD) is intended only for registered healthcare professionals who have been named and authorised by their organisation to practice under it.

Patient Group Direction

for the administration of Dapoxetine 30mg/60mg tablets (Priligy) for the treatment of Premature Ejaculation

Summary of NICE / NICE CKS Guidelines for Premature Ejaculation

Overview

Premature ejaculation (PE) is defined as persistent or recurrent ejaculation with minimal stimulation before the individual desires it. PE can be lifelong (present since the first sexual experiences) or acquired (developing after a period of normal sexual function).

Assessment

- **Sexual history:** Obtain a detailed sexual history including intravaginal ejaculatory latency time (IELT), impact on patient and partner, and relationship factors.
- **Psychological factors:** Screen for anxiety, depression, and relationship difficulties that may contribute to or result from PE.
- **Medications:** Review current medications that may affect sexual function (e.g., SSRIs, other serotonergic agents).
- **Medical conditions:** Exclude underlying prostatitis, thyroid dysfunction, and other neurological or urological conditions.

Management

- **First-line approach:** Behavioural techniques including stop-start and squeeze techniques, cognitive behavioural therapy (CBT), and couples counselling are recommended before pharmacological intervention.
- **Pharmacological options:** Dapoxetine is an on-demand SSRI approved for the treatment of premature ejaculation in men aged 18-64 years.

Red Flags

- Underlying prostatitis - refer to GP/urology
- Thyroid dysfunction - check thyroid function tests
- Neurological conditions - refer to specialist if suspected
- Severe relationship distress - consider psychological/couples therapy referral

Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

Dapoxetine 30mg/60mg tablets (Priligy)

for the treatment of

Premature Ejaculation

Healthcare professionals covered and training

	Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements
Qualifications and Registration	• Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC • Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC
Training and assessment	Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team. • All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines • All users must previously have used PGDs to supply medication • Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer • All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service
Further training and responsibilities	• All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal • All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products • All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.

PGD Indication	Treatment of premature ejaculation in adult men aged 18-64 years presenting with a history of persistent or recurrent ejaculation with minimal stimulation that causes personal distress.
Inclusion criteria	Adult males aged 18-64 years inclusive Intravaginal ejaculatory latency time (IELT) of less than 2 minutes Premature ejaculation causing significant personal distress Patient has provided informed written consent Able to understand and comply with instructions
Exclusion criteria	Age <18 years or ≥65 years Significant cardiac disorders including NYHA class II-IV heart failure Conduction abnormalities or conditions that prolong QT interval History of ischaemic heart disease Significant valvular disease History of syncope or orthostatic hypotension Concurrent use of MAOIs, thioridazine, or other SSRIs/SNRIs/tricyclic antidepressants Severe hepatic impairment (Child-Pugh class C)

	Moderate or severe renal impairment (creatinine clearance <30 mL/min) Concurrent use of potent CYP3A4 inhibitors (ketoconazole, ritonavir, etc.) History of bipolar disorder or mania
Cautions	Mild to moderate hepatic impairment - use with caution and monitor closely Moderate CYP3A4 inhibitors - may increase dapoxetine concentrations CYP2D6 poor metabolisers - may require dose adjustment Risk factors for orthostatic hypotension - advise to stand slowly Concomitant use of PDE5 inhibitors (sildenafil, tadalafil) - increased hypotension risk Bleeding disorders or concurrent anticoagulant therapy - increased bleeding risk History of seizures - dapoxetine may lower seizure threshold Hyponatraemia - monitor sodium levels, particularly during first 2 weeks
Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment	Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate.

Details of the medicine

Name, form and strength of medicine	Dapoxetine 30mg and 60mg tablets
Legal category	POM
Storage	Store below 30°C. Keep in original container. Keep out of reach of children.
Route/method of administration	Oral - swallow tablets whole with water. May be taken with or without food.
Dose and frequency	Starting dose: 30mg orally, taken 1-3 hours before anticipated sexual activity May be increased to 60mg if the 30mg dose is insufficient and well tolerated Maximum: one dose per 24-hour period Do not take on a daily basis; use only as needed before sexual activity
Quantity to be administered and/or supplied	Up to 6 tablets per supply (sufficient for up to 6 doses)

Maximum or minimum treatment period	Review efficacy and tolerability after 4 weeks of use (approximately 6 doses). Reassess every 6 months if continuing treatment. If inadequate response after 6 doses at the recommended dose, consider referral to GP or specialist.
Adverse effects	Very common (>1 in 10): Headache, dizziness, nausea Common (1 in 10 to 1 in 100): Somnolence, insomnia, fatigue, anxiety, diarrhoea, vomiting, dry mouth, erectile dysfunction, nasopharyngeal congestion, sinus congestion Uncommon (1 in 100 to 1 in 1,000): Hypotension, orthostatic hypotension, syncope, palpitations, tremor, paraesthesia Rare (<1 in 1,000): Seizures, serotonin syndrome (with concurrent serotonergic drugs), hyponatraemia, angle-closure glaucoma

Yellow card reporting	Report suspected adverse effects via https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk and inform the GP as appropriate.
Records to be kept	Record the following information: - that valid informed consent was given - name of individual, address, date of birth and GP - name of healthcare practitioner - name and brand of medication - date of supply dose, form and route quantity supplied - advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment - details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken supplied via PGD Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made. A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should also be kept for audit purposes as follows: - Adults aged 18 years and over - keep records for 8 years - Children aged under 18 years - keep records until the 25th birthday (if the patient was 17 years when treatment was finished, keep records until the 26th birthday)

Patient information

Written information to be given to patient or carer	Supply the patient information leaflet (PIL) provided with Priligy or dapoxetine product. Ensure patient understands the intended use as an on-demand medication before sexual activity.
Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer	Take the tablet 1-3 hours before sexual activity as directed - do not take on a daily basis Avoid concurrent use of alcohol as this increases the risk of dizziness and syncope

	Stand up slowly from sitting or lying down, particularly after the first dose, to minimise dizziness Maintain adequate hydration, especially in warm weather Do not drive or operate machinery if experiencing dizziness or somnolence Report any symptoms of chest pain, severe headache, or fainting immediately to your GP If you experience an erection lasting longer than 4 hours (priapism), seek immediate medical attention Inform your GP if you are using this medication, particularly before starting any new medications Do not exceed one dose per 24-hour period If symptoms do not improve after 6 doses, discuss with your healthcare provider or GP for further assessment
--	---

Key references

- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions. Published March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mg2>
- NICE MPG2 Patient group directions: competency framework for health professionals using patient group directions. Updated March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2/resources>
- NICE CKS Guidance: Premature Ejaculation
- British National Formulary (BNF) Key information on the selection, prescribing, dispensing and administration of medicines

Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates			
Name of healthcare professional	Job title	Registration number	Signature

Valid from date	Expiry date		
1/11/25	31/10/26		

PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or medicine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service.

Name of superintendent / clinical lead	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date
Name of professional group signatory	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date

Signed on behalf of Get Real Health

Name	Qualification	Signature	Date
Nitin Shori	Medical Doctor GMC: 6047293		2/11/25
Chris Pilkington	Pharmacist GPhC: 2046322		2/11/25

Change history

Version number	Change details	Date
001	Development & issue of new PGD	1st November 2025